

Researcher Guide

WRAC Research Funding Portal

Washington State Wine Commission — Research Advisory Committee

Website: <https://wrac-portal.vercel.app/>

How to register, submit proposals, and file reports.

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What this portal is

This is where you apply to the Research Advisory Committee for research funding and manage your funded projects. You'll register once, submit proposals, and—if funded—file progress and final reports here. Your account carries over from year to year, so you register only once.

To begin, open <https://wrac-portal.vercel.app/> in any web browser on a computer, tablet, or phone.

Registering

Before you can apply, you create an account and the program manager approves it.

- 1 On the website, choose to sign up.
- 2 Enter your name, institution, email, and a password, and upload your current CV.
- 3 Submit. Your account is now pending—the program manager reviews new registrations.
- 4 Once approved, you can sign in and start applying. If your registration isn't approved, you'll see a message saying so.

While you wait

Approval isn't instant—it happens when the program manager reviews your registration. You'll be able to sign in, but you won't be able to submit anything until you're approved.

How applying works

Funding runs on an annual cycle, usually in two stages:

- **Pre-proposal** (typically mid-November) — a short outline of your idea. The committee reviews these and decides which are invited to go further.
- **Full proposal** (typically January) — if your pre-proposal is advanced, you're invited to submit a complete application with a budget.

Each stage has a deadline. Your dashboard shows what's open and when it's due.

Your dashboard

When you sign in, your home screen shows:

- **Open for submission**—cycles currently accepting pre-proposals, with their deadlines and a button to start one. If you've already started a pre-proposal in a cycle, the portal says so and links to it. You can still start another if you have a second, separate project.
- **Your proposals**—everything you've started or submitted, with its current status and, once submitted, its proposal number.
- **Reports due**—if you have funded projects, any status or final reports the manager has scheduled, with their due dates.

A cycle whose pre-proposal deadline has passed stays on the list, but the button is replaced with a note telling you the deadline has gone and to contact the program manager if you need to submit late.

Submitting a pre-proposal

- 1 From your dashboard, find the open cycle and choose to start a pre-proposal.
- 2 Give your project a title, say how many years it will run, and enter an estimated amount for this year.
- 3 You're taken to the proposal's workspace. Upload the documents the manager has requested—each required document has its own slot.
- 4 You don't have to finish in one sitting. Your work saves as a draft; come back any time before the deadline.
- 5 When everything required is uploaded, review it and choose to submit.

Once you submit

A submitted proposal is locked so the committee can review a stable version. If you need to change something before the deadline, contact the program manager—they can reopen it for you. You can also withdraw it yourself; see *Withdrawing a proposal* below.

Deadlines

The submit button is only active while a cycle is open and its deadline hasn't passed. If you see "submission closed" on a draft, the window has passed or the cycle isn't accepting that type yet. The portal tells you exactly why.

If you genuinely need to submit late, contact the program manager—they can allow it for your proposal specifically.

Submitting a full proposal

If your pre-proposal is advanced, the program manager invites you to submit a full proposal. It appears on your dashboard as a new draft—you don't start it yourself.

- 1 Open the full-proposal draft from your dashboard.
- 2 Upload the full set of required documents (typically a fuller narrative, a budget, and your CV).
- 3 Fill in your multi-year budget plan if your project runs more than one year—an estimated amount for each year. Year one is what you're asking for now; the later years are your plan, which you'll formally request in future years.
- 4 If you are a WSU researcher, complete the WSU budget detail described below.
- 5 Review and submit before the deadline.

WSU budget detail

This section applies only to WSU researchers, and appears only on full proposals and continuation requests. If you are not at WSU, skip it.

WSU proposals can break out salary and wage detail that the WSU ARC fund may cover. On your full proposal, tick **This is a WSU researcher proposal** and four fields appear:

- WSU Salary
- WSU Salary Benefits
- WSU Wages
- WSU Wage Benefits

These four figures are a breakout of detail *within* your requested amount—not additional money, and they don't have to add up to the amount you requested. Press **Save WSU detail** when you're done.

Beneath the fields you'll see an **ARC-eligible (salary only)** figure. Only salary is eligible for the ARC fund, so that figure equals your salary line. It is the most of your award that the ARC fund could cover; how much actually comes from ARC is decided by the committee at funding, not by you.

Why it is worth filling in accurately

The salary and salary-benefit figures determine how much WSU can contribute toward your project from outside the Commission's budget. Getting them right helps your proposal, and costs you nothing—they do not change the amount you are requesting.

Continuing a multi-year project

If you have a funded project that runs multiple years, you re-apply each year for that year's funding—multi-year projects aren't funded all at once. The program manager invites your continuation request, which appears on your dashboard (it skips the pre-proposal step).

When you open it, you'll see what you originally projected for this year next to the amount you're now requesting—your plans can change, and you can ask for a different amount than you first estimated. Upload the required documents and submit as usual.

Ending a project early

If you need to stop a project before it's finished, you can end it from the project in your dashboard. You'll be asked for a reason, and you'll then owe a final report.

Withdrawing a proposal

You can withdraw any proposal of your own—a draft you've started, or one you've already submitted. Open the proposal and choose **Withdraw proposal** at the bottom of the page. You'll be asked to confirm before anything happens.

A withdrawn proposal is never deleted. It stays in your list marked **Rescinded**, and it is no longer considered by the committee. If you withdraw something by mistake, contact the program manager—they can restore it for you.

If the program manager withdraws an invitation

Occasionally an invitation to submit a full proposal or a continuation is issued in error. If that happens before you've started work on it, the manager can withdraw it. The draft stays on your dashboard marked **Withdrawn** and can no longer be edited, and the page explains what happened.

This can only happen while the draft is untouched. Once you've uploaded a document, entered budget figures, or submitted it, the invitation can no longer be withdrawn—your work is protected. If you see a withdrawn draft and aren't sure why, ask the program manager; a replacement invitation is usually on its way.

Your proposal number

When you submit a proposal it is given a number, shown as a small tag beside its title—for example **27-001**. The first part is the fiscal year the cycle belongs to and the second is the order of submission. If the proposal is funded, an **F** is added: **27-001F**.

A proposal has no number until it is submitted. Quote this number when you contact the program manager about a specific proposal—it is the quickest way for them to find it.

Status and final reports

Funded projects file status reports during the work and a final report at the end. Most projects have two status reports plus the final. The program manager schedules them; each appears in the **Reports due** area of your dashboard with its due date and a label saying which one it is.

- 1 Open the report from your dashboard.
- 2 Write your narrative in the text box, and upload any required documents.
- 3 Your work saves as you go. When it's complete, submit it.

A submitted report locks, like a proposal. If you need to correct it, ask the program manager to reopen it. Submitting your final report marks the project complete.

Getting help

If something isn't working or you're unsure what's expected, contact the program manager. They can see your proposals and reports, can reopen anything you need to fix before a deadline, and can allow a late submission if you genuinely need one.

Use the **Need help?** link at the top of any page, or email JTarara@washingtonwine.org directly.

Please note

The portal does not send email notifications. You'll see new invitations and scheduled reports by signing in and looking at your dashboard, so it's worth checking during an open cycle rather than waiting to be told.